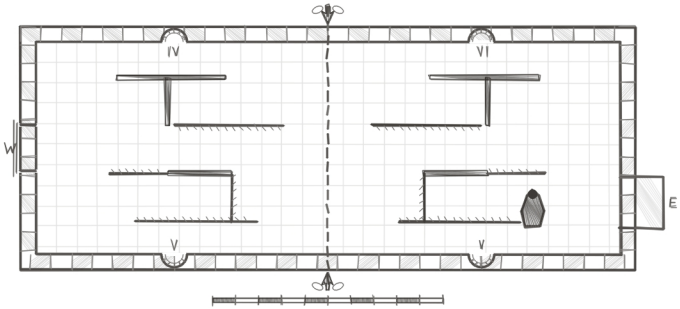
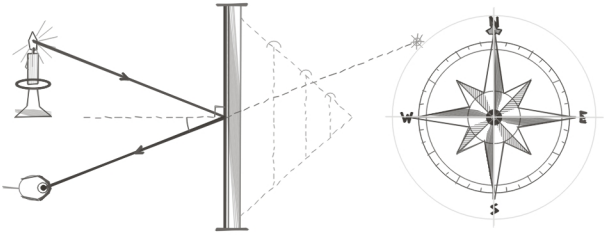
The Hall of Mirrors

A labyrinth of silvered glass fills the inner gallery. Every wall is an optical mirror, and every passage reflects a corridor that does not exist.

The compass does not turn inside the glass gallery; the mirrors rotate the light, not the earth. Count twenty Venetian paces from the Western gate: at each mirrored alcove, reject the path that duplicates your candle. Follow only the corridor where your shadow walks ahead of you.



Scala di Venti Passi Veneziani



The Rule of the Twenty Paces

Do not let the glass deceive your stride. Fold Sheet 24 along the central silver axis: the false reflections cancel against stone masonry, revealing the only unmirrored route through the twenty paces to the inner chamber.

"Never trust the corridor that reflects your own eyes; the true path reflects only the lanterns behind you."

Twenty paces from gate to sanctum: where the glass lies, the compass remembers.

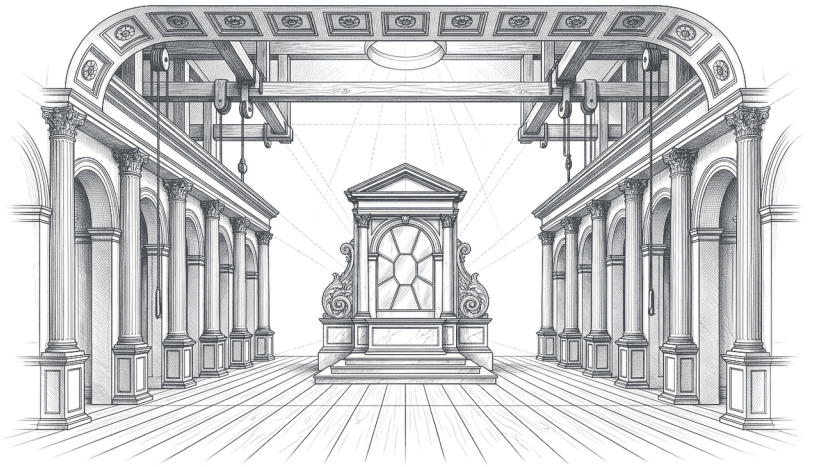
The Doctrine of the Mirror Speaker

The mirror creates no light of its own; it only returns what you bring to it. If you walk with hurried steps, you will meet only your own haste upon the glass.

The nine pieces were not broken in anger, but in kindness. A truth shared between nine rooms cannot be stolen by one pair of hands. Stand still before the threshold; when you stop reaching, the glass clears.

Bring the fragments together when the night is quiet. What you see in the completed glass is the place where our journey was always meant to end.

- The Mirror Speaker



Aurelia (1970)
Pope-E burned the ropes above the stage and filled the lower halls with smoke, but he could not cross this threshold. Some places cannot be taken by fire. They are built of quiet patience, not walls you can break. There was no gold for him to plunder here, only mirrors that turn a stranger back upon himself. By the time the Ashes reach this room, our steps will already be high in the mountains.

Hermes (1998)
Silvia, when you bring the nine pieces of glass to the stage altar, remember what the Mirror Speaker wrote. Do not look for your own face in the mirror.

The last piece does not show who holds it. When the lantern overhead shines through the prisms, the glass turns into an open window-revealing the great theater in the city where we will finally meet.

You already hold seven pieces. Only the light and the stage remain.